✦ JUPITER WISDOM TALES • ISSUE XV-B (EXECUTIVE) ✦

TWO GREEDY BEAR CUBS

Executive Case Parable on Strategy, Negotiation & The 2×2 Matrix



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TWO GREEDY BEAR CUBS

Executive Case Parable on Strategy, Governance & Decision Architecture

✦ Executive Foreword by Zinaida Jupiter, DBA ✦

Dear Founder, Executive, and Future Leader! Every enduring folktale is a compressed multi-century simulation of human incentives, negotiation errors, and institutional resilience. When an executive team shares a crisp archetypal metaphor, a 40-minute boardroom debate compresses into a 30-second course correction.

How to Work With This Executive Edition:
• **Pages 2–6:** Read the five illustrated parable acts as a live diagnostic case of team and partner behavior.
• **Pages 7–10:** Examine the 4 Organizational Archetypes, the Strategic Traps, and the **2×2 Executive Decision Matrix** (where the target state always occupies **Quadrant 4 — Top-Right ★**).
• **Pages 11–12:** Run the 5-Question Audit Checklist and deploy the Boardroom Lexicon with your leadership team.

— Zinaida Jupiter, DBA

♟ Executive Thesis of Case XV-B

"Where two brothers fight over a crumb, the cunning Fox eats the whole cheese."

Strategic Maxim: *"Where two brothers fight over a crumb, the cunning Fox eats the whole cheese."*

JUPITER PUBLISHING HOUSE • Series "Jupiter Wisdom Tales" • Issue XV-B (12+ / Executive & DBA)
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❧ Sheet I. The Sunny Forest Road and the Round Cheese Head ❧

Beyond the glassy brook in a fragrant pine forest lived two brother Bear Cubs. Setting out together to explore the wide world, they walked shoulder to shoulder until their tummies rumbled—and suddenly, right by the path, they found a large, round head of golden cheese!

They wanted to divide it fairly right away, yet a terrible worry seized them both: 'What if your half turns out a tiny crumb bigger than mine?'



❧ **Sheet II. Quarrelling Over a Millimetre and the Fox's Arrival** ❧

The two brothers growled and argued over the round cheese until their voices echoed through the woods. Hearing the noise, a sleek Fox trotted up with a sweet smile: 'Why are you shouting, young friends? Let me divide your cheese with absolute precision so neither brother is offended!'

Instead of yielding a single crumb to each other in brotherly love, the cubs gladly handed their whole treasure into the paws of the stranger.



❧ Sheet III. The 'Equalizer' Takes Bite After Bite ❧

The Fox broke the cheese head neatly in two—intentionally making one piece visibly larger than the other! The cubs cried out together: 'That piece is bigger!'

'Hush, my dears, we shall fix that right now!' purred the Fox, and took a huge bite out of the larger half—until the other half became the bigger one!



❧ Sheet IV. Chasing Imaginary Perfection Until Nothing Remains ❧

Hypnotized by the fear that the other brother might get a hair more, the Bear Cubs kept pointing at the bigger piece: 'Now THAT one is larger! Even them out!'

And the obliging Fox bit from the left piece, then from the right piece, then from the left again—until the Fox's belly was round and full, and only two tiny transparent crumbs remained in her paws!



❧ Sheet V. The Golden Rule of 'I Cut, You Choose' ❧

Handing the two microscopic crumbs to the stunned cubs, the Fox flicked her tail and laughed: 'Though small, they are now perfectly equal! Enjoy your meal, young gentlemen!'

Thus the tale teaches a lesson worth its weight in gold: envy between partners feeds only the third-party Fox, whereas a generous heart—or the simple rule 'One cuts, the other chooses'—keeps the whole cheese in the family!

“Where two brothers fight over a crumb, the cunning Fox eats the whole cheese.”

FOUR ARCHETYPES IN BUSINESS & GOVERNANCE

How the Characters of the Tale Appear in Organizations and Deals

1. The Two Bear Cubs — Deadlocked Co-Founders or JV Partners

Obsessed with relative equity slices (51% vs 49%) rather than the absolute value of the enterprise ('the whole cheese head').

2. The Round Cheese Head — Enterprise Value & Market Opportunity

A lucrative business asset that rapidly decays or gets consumed by legal/advisory fees during prolonged shareholder conflict.

3. The Fox — Opportunistic Intermediaries, Hostile Raiders & Prolonged Litigation

External actors who profit from every round of founder deadlock, 'equalizing' the company until only two crumbs of equity remain.

4. Mechanism Design ('I Cut, You Choose' / Texas Shoot-Out) — Quadrant 4 Governance

Pre-agreed shareholder clauses and cooperative bargaining that resolve disputes internally in days, keeping 100% of value inside the partnership.

ANATOMY OF MANAGEMENT TRAPS

Why Capable Teams Lose Value—and How to Shift into Quadrant 4

Trap 1 — Relative-Gain Obsession Over Absolute Enterprise Value

Preferring to own 50% of two crumbs rather than 48% of a thriving, whole-cheese enterprise.

Trap 2 — Inviting External 'Foxes' Into Unstructured Founder Disputes

Taking internal partner disagreements into protracted public litigation or hostile arbitration where fees and competitors swallow the business.

★ The Quadrant 4 Solution — Cooperative Game Theory & Self-Enforcing Deadlock Clauses

Focus on growing the total pie, yield 2% generously to preserve speed, and bake 'Cut-and-Choose' (Russian Roulette / Texas Shoot-Out) clauses into the SHA on day one.

Economic Cost of the Trap for the Enterprise

In 80% of corporate post-mortems, failure is caused not by lack of capital or market demand, but by slipping into Quadrants 1–3 of this exact behavioral model. Implementing the Quadrant 4 protocol eliminates recurring governance friction across the leadership team.

THE 2×2 EXECUTIVE DECISION MATRIX

Target Governance State in the Top-Right Quadrant (★ Quadrant 4)

↑ RETENTION OF ENTERPRISE VALUE ('THE CHEESE') →

Quadrant 2 • Internal Bureaucratic Trench War No external litigation yet, but co-founders waste 80% of executive energy auditing each other's crumbs.	**★ FULL-PIE PARTNER ALLIANCE** **High partner trust backed by self-enforcing 'Cut-and-Choose' governance—100% of value stays in the business.**
Quadrant 1 • The 'Fox's Feast' (Deadlock & Loss) Prolonged shareholder war where legal fees, delays, and competitors eat 95% of the company.	**Quadrant 3 • Unwritten Handshake Fragility** Warm feelings today without a structured deadlock mechanism if a big 'cheese' appears tomorrow.

← Zero-Sum Founder Envy **PARTNER TRUST & MECHANISM DESIGN** **Win-Win Alignment & Clear SHA Rules →**

✦ Rule of the Top-Right Quadrant (★) ✦

In the “Jupiter Wisdom Tales” methodology, **Quadrant 4 (Top-Right ★)** always represents the synthesis of two high-order capabilities. Whenever a team sacrifices either axis for short-term convenience, enterprise value degrades into Quadrants 1, 2, or 3.

4-STEP EXECUTIVE PROTOCOL

Standard Operating Procedure for Moving the Team into Quadrant 4

1. **Step 1 — Rapid Quadrant Diagnosis (2 Minutes):** Name the current pattern aloud using the shared metaphor of the tale without personal blame.

2. **Step 2 — Separate Substance from Ego & Format Friction:** Verify whether the bottleneck is on the vertical axis (execution/value) or the horizontal axis (governance/trust/clauses).

3. **Step 3 — Lock In the Quadrant 4 Mechanism:** Document the symmetrical rule, SLA, or verification milestone in writing before allocating the next tranche of capital.

4. **Step 4 — Institutionalize in the Team Lexicon:** Use the code phrases on Page 12 during weekly leadership reviews so the lesson becomes an automatic reflex.

💡 Practical Exercise for Your Next Offsite or Board Meeting

Ask each executive to place your top 3 active initiatives or partnerships into one of the four quadrants on Page 9. Wherever ratings diverge, apply the 4-Step Protocol immediately.

5 EXECUTIVE AUDIT QUESTIONS

Quarterly Checklist for Founders, Boards, and Department Heads

1. Where are we currently operating in Quadrants 1, 2, or 3?
Which project, vendor relationship, or internal workflow is repeating the exact mistake of the tale's early acts?

2. Are our agreements and SLAs specified in unambiguous metrics?
Have we eliminated vague promises so no partner can exploit a 'tops vs. roots' or 'flat-plate' loophole?

3. How fast is our psychological and operational recovery cycle?
When an error occurs, does the team waste days on ego defense, or switch immediately into Quadrant 4 problem-solving?

4. Is our core infrastructure ('brick house / two-storey Teremok') ahead of growth?
What single architectural or legal vulnerability must be reinforced this week before scaling further?

5. What single decision will we execute within 24 hours of reading this case?
Write down the owner, deadline, and measurable outcome:
_____

EXECUTIVE CODE PHRASES FROM THE TALE

Fast-Action Cultural Shorthand for Meetings & Negotiations

Code Phrase in Meeting	Diagnostic Meaning	★ Immediate Quadrant 4 Action
"Don't feed the cheese to the Fox!"	A partner dispute is dragging on and threatening to cost us the market window or excessive legal fees.	Settle within 48 hours via a 50/50 split or internal concession.
"Would you rather have 48% of a whole cheese or 50% of a crumb?"	Reframe a zero-sum equity argument around total enterprise value growth.	Approve the growth-maximizing deal structure.
"Apply 'One Cuts, the Other Chooses'"	Use a symmetric mechanism to split assets, territories, or responsibilities without an external referee.	Let Partner A package the two bundles and Partner B select first.
"Every week of deadlock is another bite out of our runway"	Time lost in internal alignment battles directly feeds competitors.	Commit to the 'Disagree and Commit' SLA.

✦ Complete 15-Volume "Jupiter Wisdom Tales" Executive Library ✦

01B. The Crane & The Heron (Negotiation Deadlocks) • **02B.** The Hare & The Fox (Asset Protection) • **03B.** Tops & Roots (Contract Specification) • **04B.** The Three Little Pigs (Risk & Architecture) • **05B.** The Golden Goose (Asset Preservation) • **06B.** Trading a Hen for a Duck (Value Discipline) • **07B.** Kolobok (Survivor Bias & Audit) • **08B.** Prince Ivan & The Grey Wolf (Mentorship & Compliance) • **09B.** The Magic Swan Geese (Crisis Ownership) • **10B.** Axe Porridge (Catalytic MVP) • **11B.** The Fox & The Crane (Customer UX Fit) • **12B.** Teremok (Team Scaling) • **13B.** The Fisherman & The Golden Fish (Sense of Measure) • **14B.** The Emperor's New Clothes (Truth Culture) • **15B.** Two Greedy Bear Cubs (Partner Deadlock Design).